

Your Journey Story

User Centered Design 2026
Departamento de Engenharia Informática

Your Joiurney Story
An Interview Guide

Student Name:

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Date:

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Target user: An everyday traveler

Neighbourhood / municipality:

Cacém / Sintra

Purpose: Understand how people get around today, and co-imagine ways of moving that are lower-impact and still work for real lives.

Welcome & Introduction

THANK YOU FOR JOINING US!

We're designing new ways for people to plan, make and look back on their everyday trips, so that the lower-impact option becomes the easy one, not the guilty one.

There are no wrong answers. We want to understand:

- How you get around today, and why
- The trade-offs you make: time, money, comfort, safety, the people you travel for
- What information and tools help you, and what gets in the way
- What would have to change for you to travel differently

You can:
- Write, draw, or sketch
- Tape in tickets, receipts, or your transit card top-up slip
- Take photos or screenshots of routes and apps (use your phone, we'll collect them later)
- Leave sections blank if they don't resonate

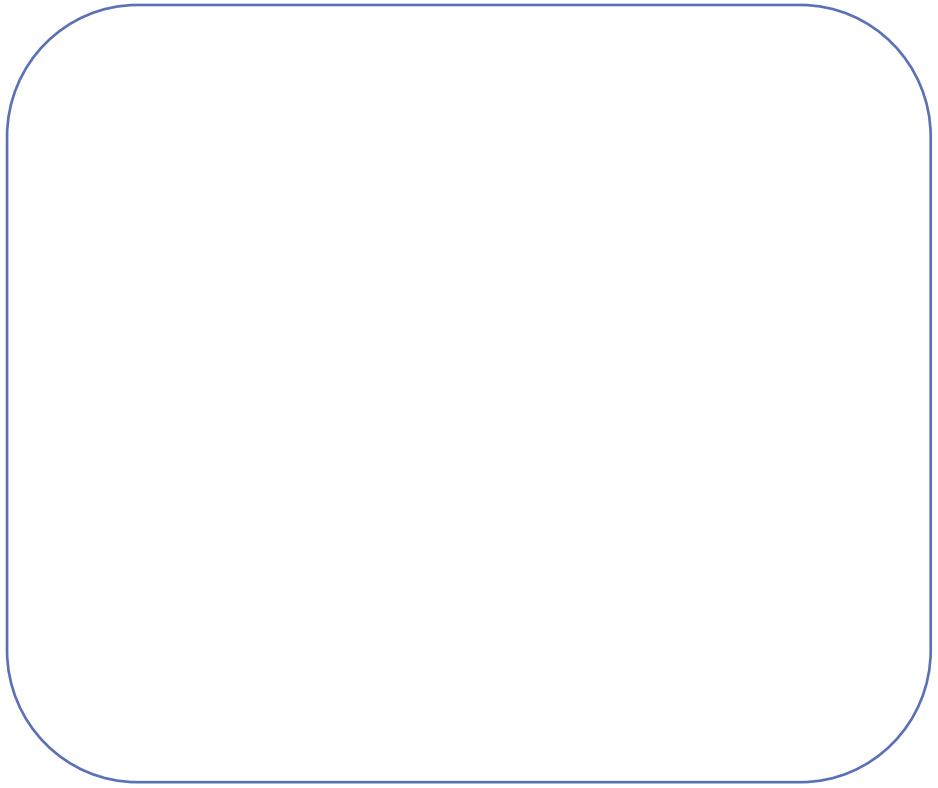
We only use what you share for this course project. You can skip any question or stop at any time.

1 Observations

1.1. YOUR TRIPS

Where you go in a normal week:

College



[SKETCH OR MAP YOUR WEEK: home, work/study, shops, school runs, care visits, leisure. Draw the lines you travel.]

Where you live:

- [ ] City centre
- [x] Inner neighbourhood
- [ ] Suburb / outer municipality
- [ ] Small town or rural area
- [ ] Other:

Who travels with you or depends on your trips (children, older relatives, colleagues, pets, shopping, tools):

I travel alone

Rhythms and seasons (school term, shifts, weather, hills, summer vs winter):

Travel depends on school schedule and weather

What makes the way you get around particular to you?

It's super convenient

1.2. HOW YOU MOVE

What makes the way you get around particular to you?

Mode	Daily	Weekly	Rarely	Never
Walking				
Own bike/ e-bike				
Shared bike or scooter				
Bus/tram				
Metro				
Train/ferry				
Own car/ motorbike				
Car share/ carpool				
Taxi/ ride-hail-ing				
Other: ___				

Passes, subscriptions and cards you hold (transit pass, bike-share, car-share, parking, tolls):

Do they fit how you actually travel?

☐ Yes-fully.

☒ Partially - explain:

They help when i need them, but I don't always need them

☐ No - why?

What do tickets, passes and maps NOT capture about how you travel?

1.3. A TYPICAL TRAVEL DAY

Document a specific day of trips:

Date:

6/12/2026

	Where from → to	Mode(s)	Time	Cost	How did it feel?
Morning	Home to tecnico	Car	5min	fuel cost	the best
Afternoon	tagus to alameda and back	Bus	1h30	Free	Good
Evening	tecnico to home	Car	30min	fuel cost	Good

1.4. THE PLANING BURDEN

Time spent planning and checking trips per week:

- [x] < 1 hour
- [ ] 1-3 hours
- [ ] 3-5 hours
- [ ] > 5 hours

How you plan:

- [x] Map / route apps
- [x] Operator apps or websites
- [ ] Paper timetables / stop signs
- [x] Memory and habit
- [ ] Asking someone
- [ ] Other: _____

What you plan for:

- [x] Not being late
- [ ] Saving money
- [x] Safety (lighting, traffic, people)
- [ ] Accessibility (steps, lifts, buggy, luggage)
- [ ] Coordinating with others
- [ ] Other: _____

Biggest planning challenges:

1. Avoiding traffic
2. Avoiding long travel times
3. _____

Trips you wish you made differently but don't:

1. Tagus to alameda and back
2. _____
3. _____

Why not?

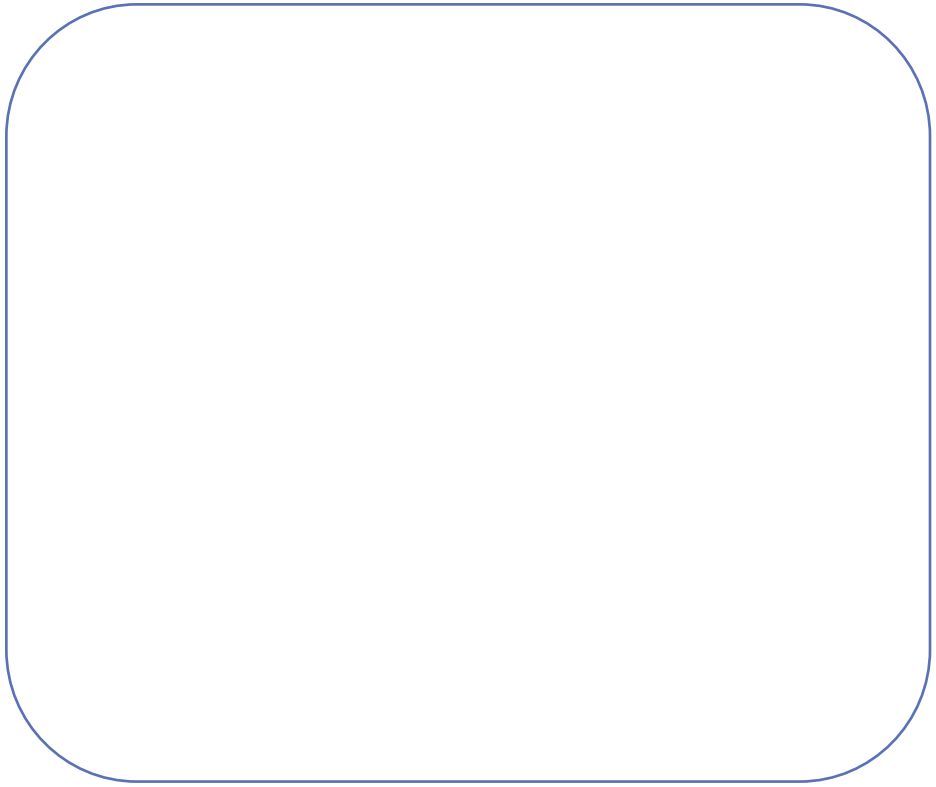
Parking is expensive so i use the bus

2 Reflections

2.1 WHAT OTHERS DON'T SEE

The people who plan streets and transport probably think:

Everything always goes perfect or close to perfect so we don't need to engineer robust solutions



[PHOTO OR SKETCH: a moment from one of your trips you'd want them to see — a good one or a bad one

Why is this important to you?

My commute is generally quick, but this makes it painfully slow and ruins part of my day

2.2. KNOWING YOUR FOOTPRINT

Do you know the environmental impact of your trips?

- [ ] Yes, roughly in numbers
- [x] I have a feeling for it
- [ ] No
- [ ] I don't think about it

Where have you seen information about it?

- [ ] Route apps (e.g. CO_2 per route)
- [x] Car dashboard / fuel costs
- [ ] Transport operator campaigns
- [ ] Employer or school
- [x] News / social media
- [ ] Nowhere
- [ ] Other: _____

Have you ever changed a trip for environmental reasons? What happened?

Not really

What works well about how that information reaches you? What's frustrating?

The information is kinda useless since the alternatives are not convinient.

Information you look for most before leaving:

1. Traffic information
2. Weather condition
3. _____

3 Choices and Costs

3.1. WHAT DRIVES YOUR CHOICES

Number your top 5 (1 = matters most):

Factor	Rank
Travel time	1
Cost	3
Reliability	1
Comfort	1
Safety	2
Health / exercise	4
Environment	3
Flexibility	1
Habit	1
Accessibility	2
Other: ___	

Roughly how your monthly travel money splits:

Public transport:
0 %

Car (fuel, parking, tolls, insurance):
100 %

Shared bikes / scooters / cars / taxis:
_____ %

Other:
_____ %

Do your choices change for different trips (commute vs shopping vs night out)? How?
Not really, I always prefer the car

3.2. THE VALUE OF LOWER-IMPACT TRAVEL

Would you accept, for a lower-impact trip:

- ☐ A slightly longer trip — up to ____ minutes more
- ☐ A slightly higher price — up to ____ € more
- ☐ Less comfort
- ☒ None of these
- ☐ Depends on: ____

Would MORE information about the impact of your trips:

- [ ] Help me choose differently
- [ ] Make me feel judged
- [x] Be ignored after a week
- [ ] Create more effort than value
- [ ] Unsure

Have you given up on a lower-impact options?

- [ ] Yes-describe: (missed connection, unsafe bike lane, no bike parking, too many changes…):

_____

_____

_____

_____

- [x] No

4 Easy Choices

4.1 YOUR IDEAL TRIP COMPANION

Imagine something that makes the lower-impact trip the easy one...

[DRAW OR DESCRIBE IT — an app, a sign at the stop, a card, a device, a change to the street]

Features you'd want:

- [x] One ticket or pass for every mode
- [x] Door-to-door planning across walking, bike, bus, metro, train
- [ ] Impact shown for each route option
- [x] Real-time delays and alternatives
- [x] Accessibility details (steps, lifts, step-free routes)
- [x] Safety details (lighting, protected bike lanes)
- [x] Voice / hands-free while moving
- [ ] Works offline
- [x] Automatic trip log (no typing)
- [ ] Rewards or discounts
- [ ] Travel with friends, family or colleagues
- [x] Works with apps and cards I already use
- [ ] Other:

4.2. THE TIME FACTOR

Maximum time you'd spend daily on documentation:

- [ ] < 1 minute
- [x] 1-5 minutes
- [ ] 5-10 minutes
- [ ] >10 minutes

When you'd want help:

- [ ] The night before
- [x] Just before leaving
- [x] On the way (when things go wrong)
- [ ] After the trip (looking back)
- [ ] Weekly/monthly summary
- [ ] Other:

What would make it WORTH the time?

The options would actually improve my life

4.3 TECH COMFORT LEVEL

Rate yourself (1-5):

Smartphones:

○ ○ ○ ○ ●

Apps:

○ ○ ○ ○ ●

Mobile payments:

○ ○ ○ ● ○

Device you'd use:

- [x] Phone
- [ ] Watch/wearable
- [x] Transit card
- [ ] Screens at stops/stations
- [x] Car or bike display
- [ ] Other:

Barriers you face:

- [ ] No smartphone or mobile data
- [x] Battery runs out
- [ ] Learning curve
- [ ] Cost
- [ ] Don't trust apps with my location
- [ ] Other:

5 Your Trip Data

5.1 WHAT YOU'D GET BACK

Imagine your trips were recorded for you, and you could see your own travel story... What would you want to see?

	Essential	Nice to have
Time spent travelling	☐	☐
Money spent	☐	☐
Emissions / impact	☐	☐
Active minutes (walking, cycling)	☐	☐
Comparison with past months	☐	☐
Comparison with neighbours	☐	☐
Suggestions for better routes	☐	☐
Other: _____	☐	☐

5.2 PRIVACY & CONTROL

Who would you share your trip data with?

	Yes	Only anony-mous	No
Friends / family			
Employer / school			
Transport operators			
City council / planners			
Researchers			
Companies (for discounts)			

Information you'd always keep private- Would you want to:

- [x] Control exactly what's shared
- [x] Delete your history at any time
- [x] Pause tracking for some trips
- [x] Share only to improve services for everyone
- [ ] Set it once and forget it
- [ ] Other:

_____

5.3 A SHARED STORY

If your neighbourhood's trips were made visible together, what would you want them to show?
Would you take part in decisions about your streets, routes or stops? How?

- [x] Online vote or survey
- [ ] Street workshop or walk
- [x] Testing a temporary change (pop-up lane, new stop)
- [ ] Not interested
- [ ] Other:

_____

6 Impact & Trust

6.1 READING THE NUMBERS

Have you seen a CO_2 figure for a trip (a route app, a flight booking, a car ad)?

- [x] No
- [ ] Yes — where?

_____

In simple terms: a car trip of 10 km emits around 1.5–2 kg of CO_2; the same trip by metro or train is a small fraction of that, and walking or cycling close to zero.
Does a number like this sound:

- [ ] Useful
- [ ] Confusing
- [ ] Guilt-inducing
- [ ] Not believable — why?
- [x] Interesting but unclear how it helps me

6.2 YOUR CONCERNS

Potential issues with tools that push "greener" travel:

- [x] Greenwashing — companies look good, nothing changes
- [ ] Unfair to people with no real alternative (shift work, care duties, disability, rural areas)
- [x] Tracking and surveillance
- [x] Who controls the data?
- [x] Points and badges get boring
- [x] Cost
- [ ] Other:

_____

Who would need to change for you to change?

- [x] The city (streets, lanes, parking)
- [x] Transport operators (frequency, prices, connections)
- [x] My employer or school (hours, remote days, showers, bike parking)
- [ ] Friends and family
- [ ] Nobody — I'd do it if it were easy enough
- [ ] Other:

_____

7 Practical Concerns

7.1 THE REAL BARRIERS

What stops you from travelling with less impact today?

- [ ] Infrastructure (no safe lanes, no bike parking, missing connections)
- [ ] Cost
- [ ] Time
- [ ] Safety
- [ ] Care duties (children, relatives, shopping)
- [ ] Weather or hills
- [ ] Health or physical effort
- [x] Habit
- [ ] Other:

_____

7.2 ECONOMIC REALITY

Would you pay for a service that made lower-impact trips easier?

- [ ] Yes — up to ____ per month/year
- [x] No
- [ ] Only if it pays for itself through: ____
- [ ] Unsure

7.3 SUPPORT YOU'D NEED

To change how you travel, you'd need:

- [ ] A free or discounted trial period
- [ ] Someone to plan the first trips with me
- [ ] Training (e.g. cycling in traffic, using the app)
- [x] Safe storage for a bike or scooter
- [ ] A group of others doing the same
- [ ] Incentives from my employer or school
- [ ] Accessibility assistance
- [ ] Other:

_____

Who should provide this support?

The promoter of the change

7.4 QUESTIONS FOR US

What should we make sure our design addresses?

1. Actually provides alternatives that are worthwhile for the user, not just "greener"
2. Privacy concerns, I want to plan my routes and use them to help other but only while I remain anonymous
3.

Who else should we talk to?

- Other travellers: ____
- Drivers / operators: ____
- City council / planners: ____
- Employers / schools: ____
- Other: ____

Colophon

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